

Word family: **example / examples / exemplary / exemplify / exemplification**

Base word: example

Plural: examples

Related forms: exemplary, exemplify, exemplification

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / related adjective and verb forms (相關形容詞及動詞)

Your sentence:

> “He did not teach me through theory alone; he taught me through action, repetition, and **example**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **example** means **behaviour or actions that other people can learn from and imitate**.

Your grandfather did not only explain patience verbally; he **demonstrated it through the way he behaved and worked**.

繁體中文： **以自己的行為、做法或態度作為別人可以學習和模仿的示範；榜樣 / 身教**

中文翻譯：

> “...he taught me through action, repetition, and **example**.”

「.....他透過行動、重複，以及自己的**榜樣 / 身教**來教我。」

Here:

teach by example = 以自己的行為作示範，讓別人從中學習

1. **example = instance used to illustrate something (例子) — 例子；實例**

This is the most general and common meaning.

Meaning: A particular case, situation, object, or event used to show what a general idea is like.

Practice 1

> “Let me give you an **example**.”

「讓我給你一個**例子**。」

Practice 2

> “This sentence is a good **example** of formal English.”

「這個句子是正式英語的一個很好**例子**。」

example = 用來說明、證明或展示某個較一般概念的具體個案 / 實例

Common:

- * give an example
- * for example
- * a good example of
- * an example sentence
- * real-life example

2. **example** = person/behaviour worth copying (榜樣 / 示範) — 榜樣 ; 身教 ; 示範

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A person, action, or way of behaving that shows others how they should act.

Practice 3 — Original

> “He taught me through action, repetition, and **example**.”

「他透過行動、重複和**身教 / 榜樣**來教我。」

Practice 4

> “Parents often teach their children by **example**.”

「父母常常透過**身教**來教導孩子。」

Practice 5

> “She set a good **example** for the younger students.”

「她為年幼學生樹立了良好的**榜樣**。」

example = 某人的行為或做法可供別人觀察、學習和模仿的榜樣 / 示範

This is genuinely distinct from merely giving an illustrative example.

3. **example** = typical representative of a type (典型代表) — 典型 ; 代表例子

Example can mean a person or thing that represents a category especially well.

Practice 6

> “This building is a fine **example** of modern architecture.”

「這座建築是現代建築的一個典型代表例子。」

Practice 7

> “The animal is a rare **example** of the species.”

「這隻動物是該物種一個罕見的例子 / 代表個體。」

example = 某一類事物中具有代表性、能反映該類特徵的個體或案例

This overlaps with Meaning 1, but the emphasis shifts from:

* **used to explain something**

to

* **representative of a category**

For strict core counting, I would usually merge it with Meaning 1 under the broad **illustrative/representative instance** concept.

4. **example** = warning from what happened to someone (警戒例子) — 前車之鑑 ; 警戒

Sometimes **example** refers to a person or case used to warn others what may happen if they behave badly.

Practice 8

> “The punishment was intended to make an **example** of him.”

「這項懲罰是要拿他來殺雞儆猴 / 作警戒。」

Practice 9

> “The incident became an **example** of what not to do.”

「這宗事件成為一個反面教材 / 警戒例子。」

****example** = 被用來警告別人、顯示某種錯誤行為可能後果的案例******

This is a distinct pragmatic use, though it still grows from the broader idea of ****something others learn from****.

Useful expression: ****for example** — 例如******

Practice 10

> “Some fruits, for ****example**** apples and oranges, are rich in vitamins.”

「有些水果，****例如****蘋果和橙，含有豐富維他命。」

Practice 11

> “You could, for ****example****, study one hour each evening.”

「你****例如****可以每晚溫習一小時。」

****for example** = 用來引出一個具體例子******

This belongs to Meaning 1.

Useful expression: ****set an example** — 樹立榜樣******

Practice 12

> “Older students should ****set a good example****.”

「高年級學生應該****樹立好榜樣****。」

Practice 13

> “His patience set an ****example**** for everyone else.”

「他的耐性為其他人樹立了****榜樣****。」

This belongs to Meaning 2.

Useful expression: **lead by example** — 以身作則

Practice 14

> “Good managers **lead by example**.”

「好的管理者會**以身作則**。」

Practice 15

> “She never asked others to do anything she would not do herself; she **led by example**.”

「她從不要求別人做自己不願做的事；她一直**以身作則**。」

lead by example = 自己先做出正確行為，讓別人跟隨

This is very close to your passage.

Useful expression: **make an example of someone** — 殺雞儆猴；懲一儆百

Practice 16

> “The coach made an **example of** the player who repeatedly ignored the rules.”

「教練拿那名屢次無視規則的球員來**殺雞儆猴**。」

Practice 17

> “They wanted to make an **example of** him.”

「他們想拿他來**懲一儆百**。」

make an example of someone = 對某人作出明顯懲罰，以警告其他人

This belongs to Meaning 4.

Related form: **exemplary**

Exemplary means extremely good and worthy of being copied.

Practice 18

> “Her behaviour was **exemplary**.”

「她的行為堪稱**模範 / 典範**。」

Practice 19

> “He showed **exemplary** patience.”

「他展現了**堪作榜樣的耐性**。」

exemplary = 非常優秀、值得別人仿效的；典範性的

Related form: **exemplify**

Exemplify means to be a very clear example of a quality, idea, or type.

Practice 20

> “His actions **exemplify** patience.”

「他的行動**充分體現 / 例證了耐性**。」

Practice 21

> “This case **exemplifies** the problem perfectly.”

「這個案例非常清楚地**體現 / 說明了這個問題**。」

exemplify = 成為某種特質、概念或類型的清楚例證 / 體現

Related form: **exemplification**

This is more formal and academic.

Practice 22

> “The paragraph uses **exemplification** to explain the idea.”

「這一段運用**舉例說明**來解釋這個概念。」

exemplification = 透過例子來說明某個概念的方式 / 過程

This is useful academically but lower priority than **example / exemplary / exemplify**.

Important distinction: **example vs instance**

example

often means a case used to illustrate or represent something.

instance

means one particular occurrence or case.

> “This is an example of polite language.”

focuses on illustration.

> “In one instance, the system failed.”

focuses on one occurrence.

They overlap, but **example** is much more natural in teaching.

Important distinction: **example vs sample**

example

= one case used to illustrate a broader idea

sample

= a small amount or selection taken from a larger whole, often for testing or representation

> example sentence = 例句

> blood sample = 血液樣本

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **example vs model**

example

can mean a person/behaviour others should copy.

****model****

can also mean an ideal pattern or standard to imitate, but has many other meanings.

> “He set a good example.”

very natural.

> “He was a role model.”

also natural, but emphasizes the person more than the specific behaviour.

Important distinction: ****example vs evidence****

****example****

shows what something is like.

****evidence****

supports whether a claim is true.

An example may support an argument, but:

> example ≠ proof automatically

This distinction matters in academic writing.

Countability note

****Example**** is normally countable:

> an example

> two examples

> several examples

But in expressions such as:

> by example

it appears without an article because it refers to the method of demonstrating behaviour.

This is exactly what happens in your passage:

> **teach through example**

= **透過身教 / 示範來教**

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **example**

* **examples**

* **exemplary**

* **exemplify**

* **exemplification**

Useful constructions include:

* for example

* give an example

* example of

* set an example

* lead by example

* make an example of someone

The Golden Manual says useful family extensions and fixed expressions should be included when they add real learning value, while closely related contexts should still be merged into broader semantic concepts where appropriate.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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example — illustrative instance	用來說明、展示或代表某個一般概念的具體案例 / 例子
example — model behaviour	某人的行為或做法可供別人觀察、學習和模仿的榜樣
/ 示範	
example — representative specimen/case	某類事物中具有代表性、能反映該類特徵的個體或案例；與 illustrative-instance 義相關
example — warning case	被用來警告別人、顯示錯誤行為後果的案例 / 反面教材

exemplary	非常優秀、值得別人仿效的；模範的	
exemplify	成為某種特質、概念或類型的清楚例證 / 體現	
exemplification	透過例子來說明概念的過程或方法	

For your original sentence

> “He did not teach me through theory alone; he taught me through action, repetition, and **example**.”

The exact meaning is:

example = 自己做出可以讓別人學習和模仿的行為示範

So:

> **teach through example**

= **透過身教 / 以自己的行為作榜樣來教**

The contrast is:

> **theory** = 把道理說出來

> **example** = 自己實際做給對方看

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **example**:

1. **a concrete instance used to illustrate or represent something**
2. **a person/behaviour that others can learn from or imitate**
3. **a warning case used to show others what happens if they behave badly**

I would merge **representative example** into #1, and keep **for example, set an example, lead by example, make an example of**, plus **exemplary / exemplify**, as fixed or family extensions rather than inflate the core count.